

WHAT-HOW

PRIMARY WHAT · SECONDARY HOW · TERTIARY WHY

How the WHAT-HOW communicates

How your wiring shows up in writing and speech, how each orientation hears it, and the three adjustments that buy the most understanding.

HOW YOU NATURALLY WRITE

You write like a cockpit: status, metrics, next actions, all instruments live. Short lines, real numbers, clear sequence, and you can drop into detail and pull back up without losing the thread. What thins out is the why: the purpose framing, the audience meaning, the sentence that says what all of it is for. Readers get an accurate picture and are left to conclude for themselves why it matters.

Your signature

PRESENT

- + Conclusion-first; actions with owners and dates
- + Real metrics and current status, always
- + Detail on demand: steps, sequence, iteration notes
- + "Good enough to ship, tweak from there" energy

CONSPICUOUSLY ABSENT

- The purpose frame: "this matters because"
- The audience's so-what
- The zoom-out to the bigger picture
- The reframe question: is this the right problem?

HOW YOU LAND

WHAT readers

Hear a native speaker. Your updates are the ones they forward.

HOW readers

Trust your numbers and sequence; they may want the edge cases you skipped in the name of pace.

WHY readers

See motion without meaning. Metrics with no frame read as activity, not progress, and they will ask what it is all for, usually in the meeting you least want it.

THE BLIND SPOT

To a WHY reader, a perfect status update with no purpose line is noise with numbers. They are not asking for poetry, they are asking which decision your data serves. One sentence of meaning at the top changes how every figure below it is read, and it is the sentence your wiring skips.

For WHY readers

Open with the one-line why: "we are doing this so that X", before the first metric. Borrow it from the North Star page; never regenerate it under pressure.

For HOW readers

Keep an appendix habit. Your compression is a gift to most readers; give precision wiring the full detail one layer down.

Everywhere

Translate one metric per message. Pick the number that matters most and complete "which means that" for the reader. Meaning is a habit, not a talent.